Install Python

Digital Technologies · Personal computers

You will

- download the Python installer
- install Python with Add python.exe to PATH ticked
- check Python works

You need

- a Windows computer you're allowed to install apps on (Chromebooks can't run Python: ask your kaiako about an online editor)
- VS Code, if you'll write Python in it (see the guide Install VS Code)

Before you start

- The one box that matters is Add python.exe to PATH. It's unticked at first.
- School computers already have Python.

 Click here  Look here

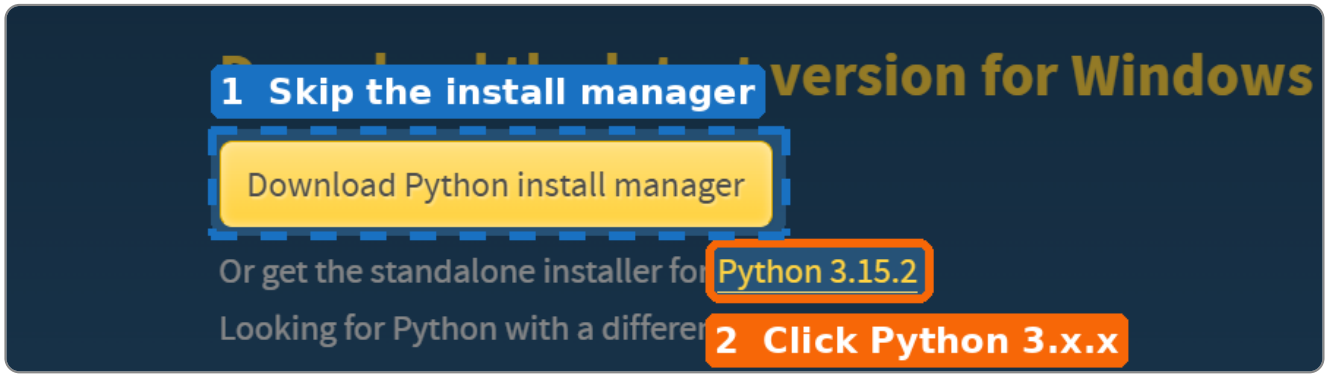
1

Chrome › python.org/downloads

Go to `python.org/downloads`.

Next to **Or get the standalone installer for**, click the Python version link.

Skip the yellow **Download Python install manager** button. This guide uses the standalone installer.

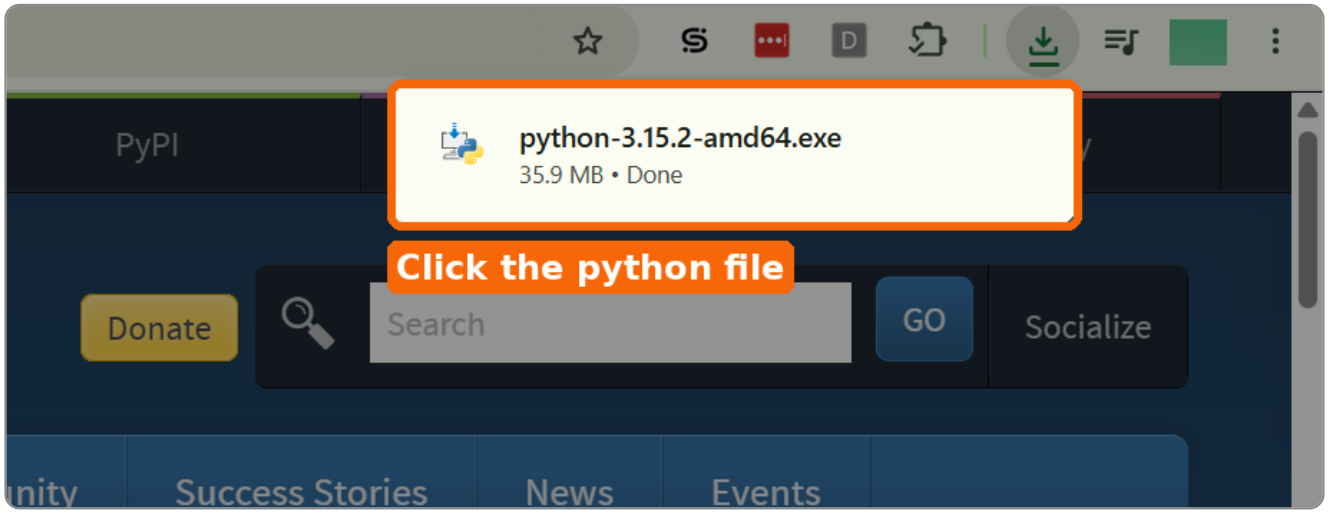


2

Chrome › Downloads

When it says Done, click the python file.

Can't see it? Press Ctrl + J to open your downloads.



3

Python Setup › Install Python

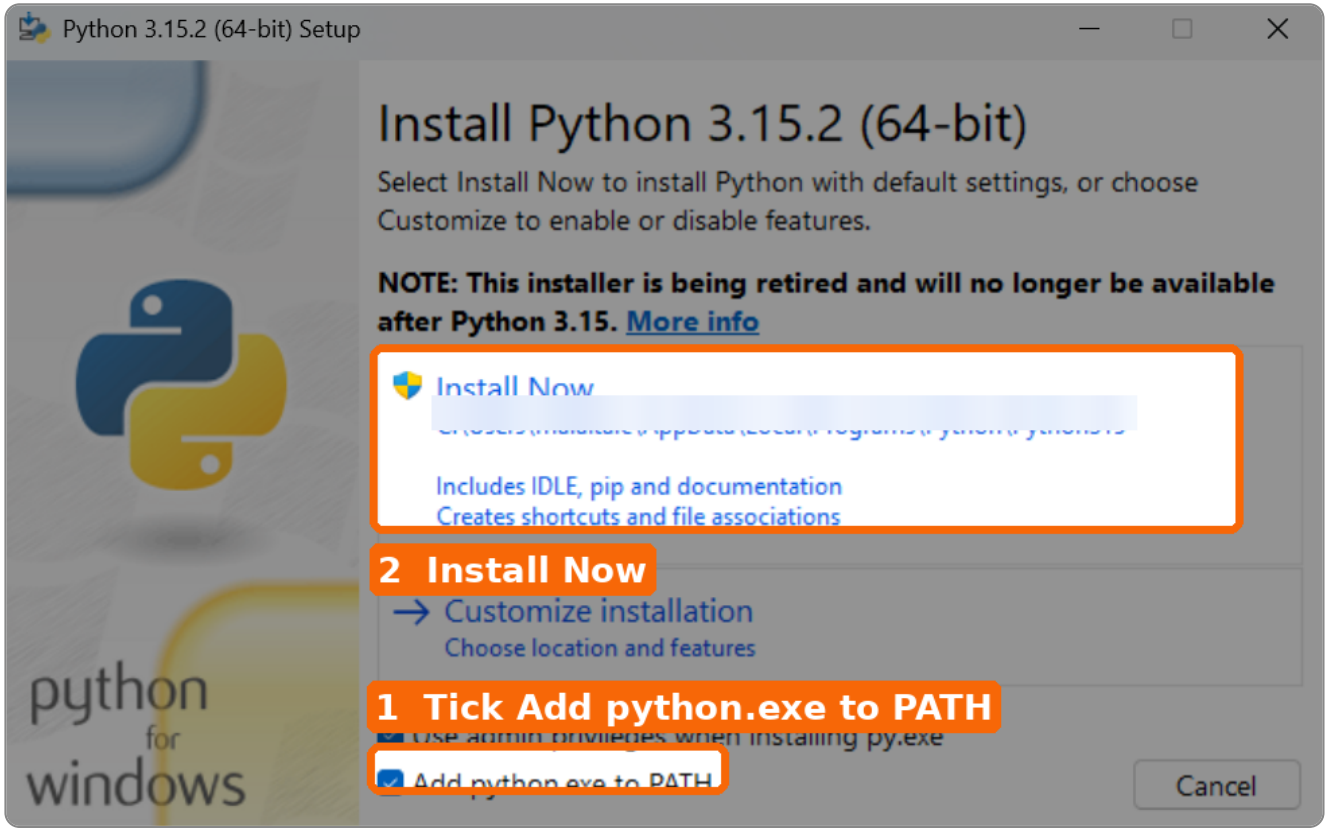
Tick **Add python.exe to PATH** at the bottom.

Click **Install Now**.

If Windows asks whether to allow the app to make changes, click **Yes**.

PATH lets VS Code and Command Prompt find Python.

If something goes wrong
You missed the PATH box: run the installer again, click Modify, then Next, and tick Add Python to environment variables.



4

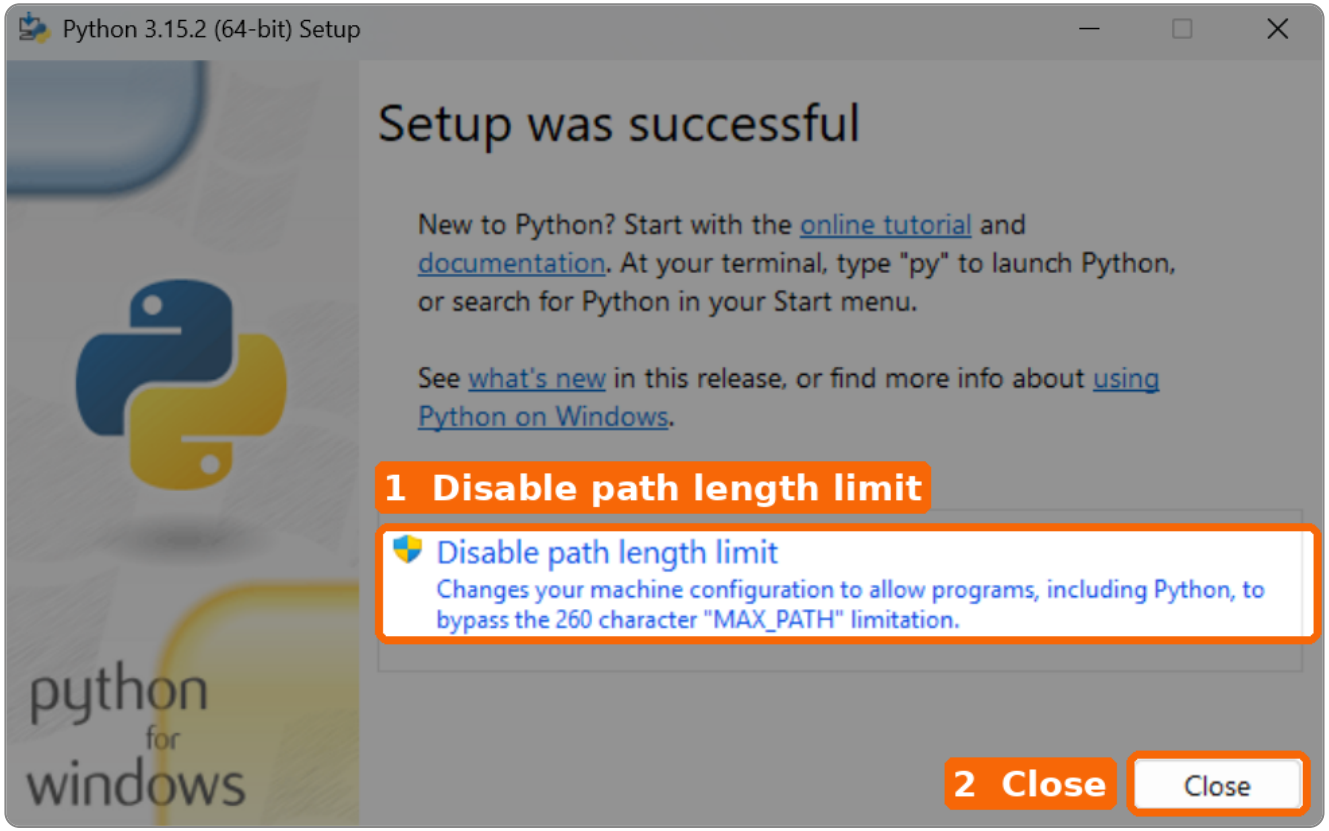
Python Setup › Setup was successful

Click **Disable path length limit**, then **Yes**.

Click **Close**.

This lets Python use files in deep folders. If the button isn't there, just click Close.

Check: "Setup was successful".



Check it works

Click Start, type `cmd` and open Command Prompt. Type `python --version` and press Enter. You should see Python and a version number.

Next

In VS Code, install the Python extension (see the guide Install VS Code extensions).

Checkpoint

- [ ] I can install Python.
- [ ] Add python.exe to PATH was ticked.
- [ ] `python --version` shows a version number.